

The One With The Football

Learn English with a 90s Sitcom Classic: Vocabulary, Culture, and Comprehension

Gemini Notebook

What is Thanksgiving Touch Football?



In the United States, families often play a friendly game of American football outside before eating their heavy Thanksgiving dinner.



Touch football means simply tapping the player instead of violently tackling them to the ground. (Though the characters in this episode quickly forget that rule!)

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The Ultimate Prize: The Geller Cup

A plastic troll doll, rescued from the bottom of a lake.

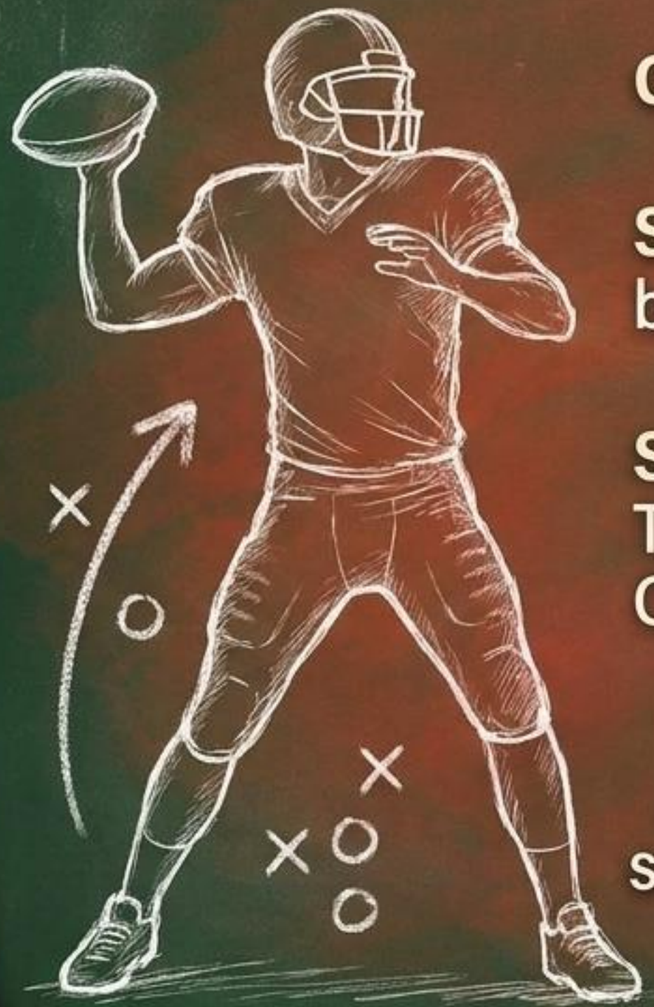
Nailed to a piece of scrap wood.



Ross and Monica were banned from playing football for 12 years because their Geller Bowl VI childhood game ended with a broken nose. They are playing today to win back this ugly trophy!

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Team Ross vs. Team Monica



Captain: Ross.

Style: Strategic but whiny.

Secret Weapon: The Down and Out play.

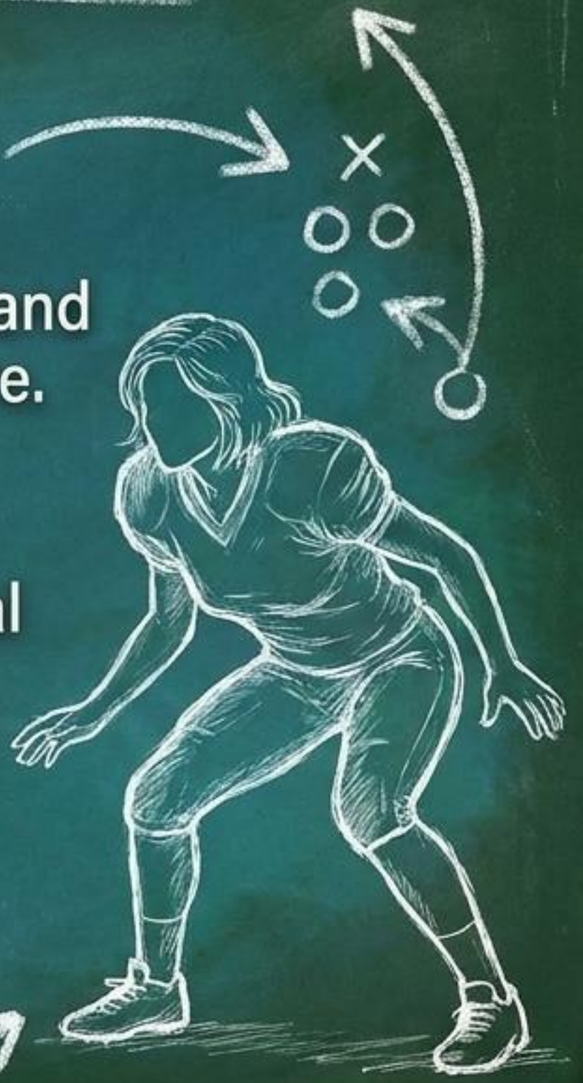
Motivation: Prove he is the smarter, stronger older brother.

Captain: Monica.

Style: Aggressive and fiercely competitive.

Secret Weapon: Accidental physical violence.

Motivation: Beat Ross at any cost and claim the Geller Cup.



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Action Vocabulary



To Huddle: To gather closely in a circle to plan a strategy before a play.



To Fumble: To clumsily drop the ball while holding it or trying to catch it.



To Tackle: To physically grab someone and knock them to the ground.

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Sitcom Slang
"Go long"
Run very far away down the field to catch a long pass.
"Bunny up"
A childish method of choosing teams by putting two fingers behind your head like rabbit ears.
"Cut to the chase"
Skip the small talk and get straight to the main point.
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The Subplot: A Total Distraction

While Monica and Ross fight for the trophy, Joey and Chandler completely ignore the game to fight for the attention of a Dutch woman named Margha.

The Result: Because the men are so busy showing off, their team starts losing badly. Ultimately, Margha rejects both of them, calling them shallow and a dork.



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The Underdog:
Rachel's Big Moment

Rachel is ignored all game, told to just go long, and feels totally useless. But in the final seconds of a tied game, Monica trusts her with a desperate, slow-motion pass.





The Climax: She catches it!

...But the celebration stops when when they realize she missed the end-zone by exactly five feet.

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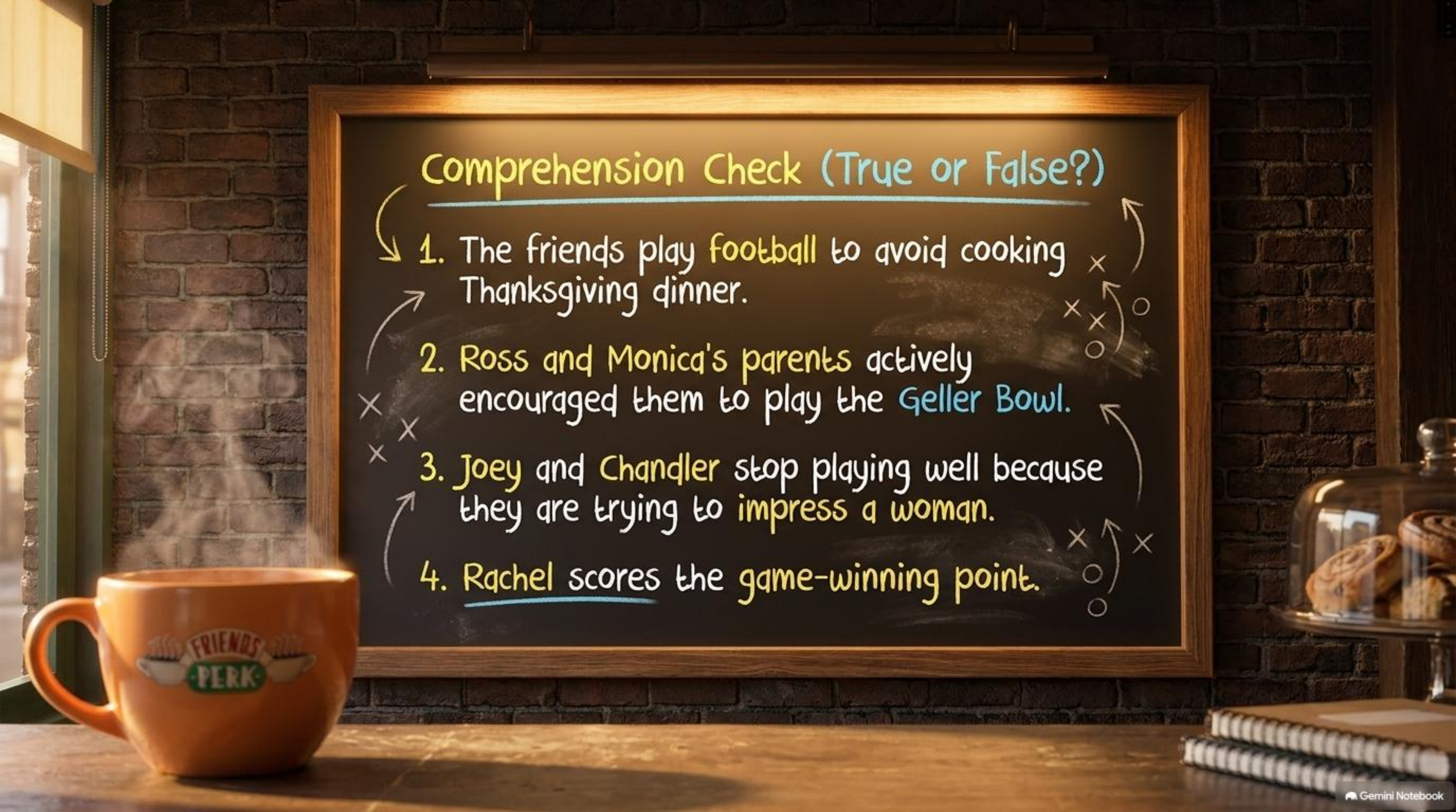
The Resolution: The Endless Standoff

The rest of the friends realize that winning a childhood game doesn't actually matter. They go inside to eat an amazing Thanksgiving dinner together.

Ross and Monica, completely trapped by their own stubbornness, stay outside freezing in the snow, refusing to drop the ball.



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Comprehension Check (True or False?)
1. The friends play football to avoid cooking Thanksgiving dinner.
2. Ross and Monica's parents actively encouraged them to play the Geller Bowl.
3. Joey and Chandler stop playing well because they are trying to impress a woman.
4. Rachel scores the game-winning point.
FRIENDS
PERK
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Short Answer Questions

1. What exactly is the Geller Cup made out of?

2. What does it mean when a football player is told to go long?

3. Why did Margha ultimately reject both Chandler and Joey?

Think about your answers before checking the next slide!

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Check Your Answers!

1. Falce (They were cooking while the guye watched TV)

2. False (They were banned for 12 years!)

3. True

4. False (She mieced the end-zone by five feet)

1. A Troll doll nailed to a piece of wood.

2. To run very far down the field to catch a pacc.

3. Becauce they were acting shallow and a dork.

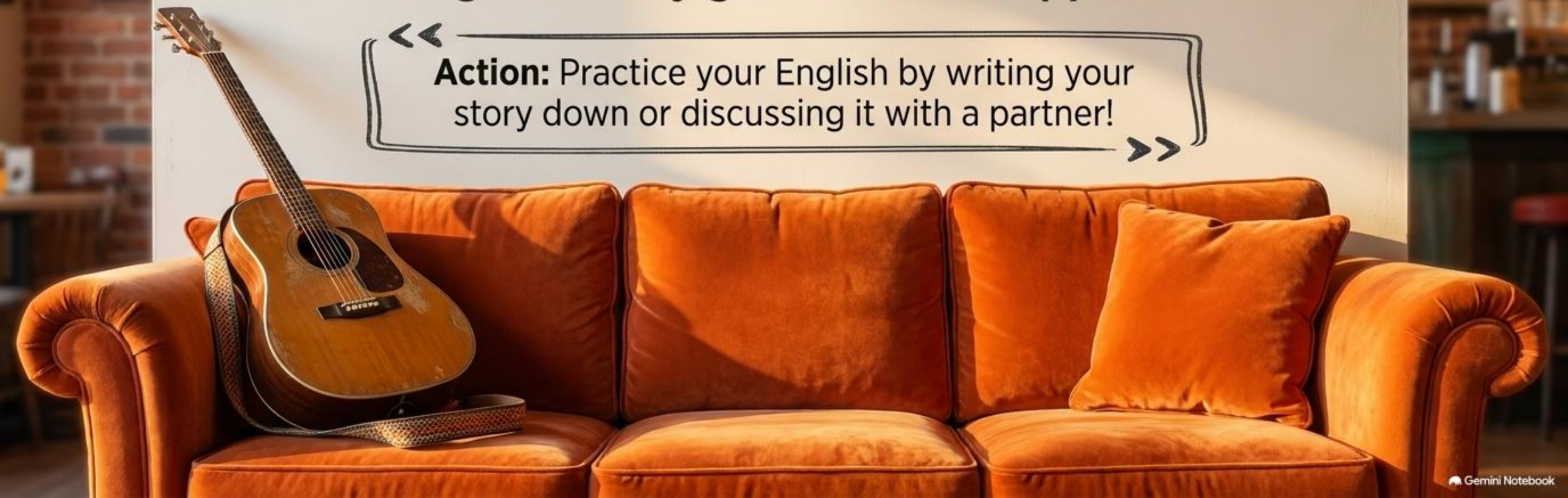
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Over to You!

Prompt: Ross and Monica let their extreme competitiveness ruin their Thanksgiving dinner, standing in the snow for hours.

Question: Have you ever been too competitive during a friendly game? What happened?

Action: Practice your English by writing your story down or discussing it with a partner!



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